

Phase I-III: Empowering Voices, Nurturing Seas in Gujarat, Maharashtra and Daman-Diu

Combining the transformative phases of "Sagar Parikrama" in Gujarat, the program's inaugural phase embarked on a poignant journey on March 5, 2022. Started from Mandvi, Gujarat, the maritime odyssey traced its course through Okha-Dwarka to Porbandar, drawing over 5000 enthusiastic participants and a virtual audience of around 10,000. Phase I illuminated fisher folk and stakeholders about beneficiary-oriented Government schemes, with interactive sessions showcasing sustainable coastal livelihood practices.

Continuing this transformative journey, Phase II unfolded as a heartfelt tribute to the seas and the valour of our freedom fighters, sailors, and fishers. Setting sail from Mangrol to Madhwad in Gujarat, Phase II engaged over 20,000 attendees physically and approximately 15,000 virtually. Navigating through seven significant locations, the maritime trail fostered direct interactions with fishermen and fisherwomen, unravelling the challenges faced by coastal communities. From Mangrol to Vanakbara, the coastal tapestry woven from the threads of the Arabian Sea unfolded as a rhythmic progression. The success of Phase II echoed in certificates and sanction of financial assistance related to flagship schemes, solidifying the foundation for an empowered coastal community.

Phase III, unfolding in Surat, Gujarat, and culminating at Sasson Dock, Mumbai in February 2023, resonated with gratitude and empowerment. Fishermen hailed Prime Minister Narendra Modi for newfound empowerment, welcoming Shri. Parshottam Rupala with Koli Band and Tilak Poojan. Beyond routine interactions, Phase III became a platform for recognition, honouring courageous freedom fighter like Shri Sachin Karmekar. The program extended beyond events, showcasing a futuristic approach for promotion of domestic fish consumption by sales of fish & aquaculture products through e-marketing and online platform like Zomato, Licious and fresh to home. Shri Eknath Shinde, Chief Minister, Govt. of Maharashtra, Shri Sudhir Mungantiwar, Minister for Fisheries, Government of Maharashtra and Shri Ram Naik, former Governor and senior leader also joined the Sagar Parikrama Yatra.

Phase IV: Nurturing Ground Realities, Paving the Way for Progress

The fourth leg of "Sagar Parikrama" unfolded with resounding success, as fishers, fish farmers and dignitaries converged to voice their challenges and aspirations at Majali, Karwar Port, and Malpe Harbour. Attracting around 1,000 participants in Majali and a staggering 4,000 in Malpe contributed to a vibrant exchange of knowledge and ideas transforming the event into a dynamic platform for the coastal community. Yatra was welcomed at Malpe Harbour with Dhoomanodhi Chende, Kotakori Singarimebam dance of fishermen.

Commencing from Goa in March 2023 and culminating at various locations in Karnataka, the journey covered an expansive stretch of the coastal belt. The engagement was a conduit for sharing ground realities, fostering dialogues, and charting a course for the development of the fisheries sector. Hon'ble Minister of State for Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying, GoI, Dr. L Murugan, underscored the importance of a holistic approach for rural livelihood development, aligning with Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

The interactive sessions between Shri Parshottam Rupala and the coastal communities & beneficiaries proved invaluable. Issues such as the supply of Diesel and Kerosene for boats, subsidies for engine boats, support for elderly non-fishing fishermen & fisherwomen social security, establishment of fisheries industrial zones and development of coastal fishing villages were brought to the forefront.

Sagar Parikrama also promoted the 'Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyan' of Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment amongst coastal communities especially to the fishermen who are most susceptible to addictions due to low level of education, backwardness and their marginalized situations.

Phase V: Navigating New Horizons in Fisheries Development

Shri Parshottam Rupala embarked on the momentous journey of Sagar Parikrama Phase V from the iconic Gateway of India, Mumbai. The event, observed by the Department of Fisheries, Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying, Government of India and National Fisheries Development Board, unfolded with ceremonial grace at Karanja (Raigad Dist.), where the lighting of the lamp marked the inauguration.

The Hon'ble Minister addressed an assembly of about 6000 fisherfolk, fish farmers, and dignitaries, emphasizing the significance of the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY) scheme and transformative initiatives under the Blue Revolution. Volunteers were urged to contribute to the awareness of these schemes for maximum outreach. Throughout the event, stakeholders, including Secretary of Fisheries, Government of Maharashtra, Chief Executive, NFDB, MPs/MLAs/MLCs representatives, and officials expressed gratitude and underscored the importance given to the fisheries sector. Shri Abhilaksh Likhi, IAS, OSD, Government of India, highlighted the special funds allocated to the fisheries sector and projects sanctioned for the development of fisheries sector in the state of Maharashtra under schemes like Blue Revolution and PMMSY.

Phase VI: Nurturing Prosperity in Andaman & Nicobar Islands

The vibrant journey of Sagar Parikrama Phase VI unfolded in the picturesque Andaman & Nicobar Islands, commencing on 29th May 2023. Secretary (Fisheries), Government of Andaman & Nicobar Islands, acknowledged the event's significance and the importance of island's vast exclusive economic zones constituting 28% of the country's maritime expanse.

Nearly 2,000 attendees, including fishermen, fisherwoman and other stakeholders participated in the event physically , with an additional 12,500 viewers witnessing the live-streamed program on social platforms like YouTube, Twitter, and Facebook. The event has created an excellent platform for an impactful exploration of the island's fisheries potential.

Acknowledging the indispensable role of fish farmers and the tireless efforts of fisherfolk, Shri Parshottam Rupala recognized their contributions. Promotion of deep-sea fishing, Sustainable fishing practices, productivity enhancement, and minimizing environmental impact were underscored. KCC camps facilitated card distribution, empowering fishermen , fisherwomen and fish farmers.

Phase VII: Empowering Coastal Communities in Karnataka, Kerala and Puducherry

Embarking on the coastal realms of Kerala and Puducherry , Sagar Parikrama Phase VII unfolded a metamorphic journey covering varied locations such as Mangalore, Kasargode, Madakkara, Pallikkara, Chalium, Kanhangadu, Kozhikode, Mahe (Puducherry), Beypore, Thrissur, Ernakulam, Kochi. During the course of journey, the Government inducted a pre-saturation Sagar Parikrama for 5 days to create awareness on Government